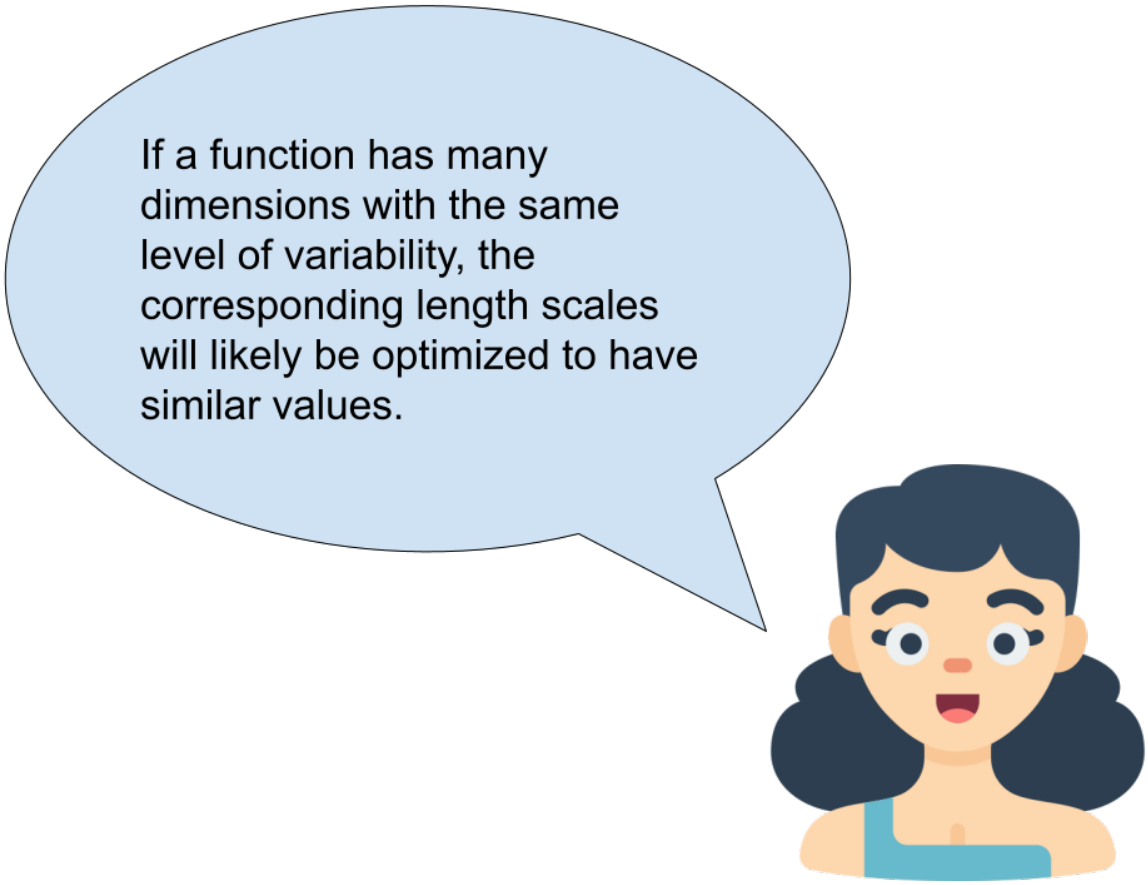


SIDEBAR **More reading on kernels**

Kernels in and of themselves have enjoyed a lot of interest from the machine learning community. For a more thorough and technical discussion on kernels and their roles in machine learning, the interested reader may refer to David Duvenaud's The Kernel Cookbook (https://www.cs.toronto.edu/~duvenaud/cookbook/).

This discussion marks the end of Chapter 3. Throughout this chapter, we have extensively investigate how our GP model is influenced by the mean and the covariance functions, specifically by their various parameters. We use this as a way to incorporate what we know about the objective function, that is, prior information, into our GP models. We have also learned to use gradient descent to estimate the values for these parameters to obtain the GP model that explains our data the best.

This also marks the end of the first part of the book on Gaussian processes. Starting from the next chapter, we will start learning about the second component of the Bayesian optimization framework: decision-making. We begin with two of the most commonly used Bayesian optimization policies that seek to improve from the best point seen.

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